

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 5-00-054

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR
NACO WEST AND THOUSAND TRAILS, INC.,
YOSEMITE LAKES CAMPGROUND
WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITY
TUOLUMNE COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. Naco West and Thousand Trails Inc. (hereafter Discharger) operate the Yosemite Lakes Campground. The property (Assessor's Parcel Number 68-33-09) is owned by Thousand Trails, Incorporated.
2. On 28 December 1999, Discharger submitted a Report of Waste Discharge to discharge its treated wastewater to land. Supplemental information was submitted on 6 January 2000. The wastewater treatment and disposal facilities are owned and operated by the Discharger.
3. Order No. 86-156, adopted by the Board on 8 August 1986, prescribes requirements for an extended aeration package treatment plant, a polishing pond, and discharge to percolation beds. Order No. 86-156 is neither adequate nor consistent with current plans and policies of the Board.
4. Yosemite Lakes Campground is located on approximately 12 acres of land at an elevation of 3,700 feet. The facility is at 31191 Hardin Flat Road, off State Highway 120, approximately 18 miles east of Groveland. The wastewater treatment and disposal facilities are in Section 36, T1S, R18E, MDB&M with surface water drainage to the South Fork Tuolumne River as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and made part of the Order by reference.
5. Yosemite Lakes Campground provides 431 campsites. The site facilities can accommodate approximately 2,150 people. During the off-season, from October through April, the facility is occupied only by a small number of employees (approximately five).
6. Recreational vehicles can connect to the waste collection system. There are provisions for 267 recreational vehicle connections. The 164 campsites which are not connected to the sewer system are served by public toilets and showers.
7. The wastewater treatment plant is designed to treat average dry weather flows up to 50,000 gallons per day (gpd). Wastewater generation at the facility is seasonal. Peak flows occur between May and September. Typical flow rates in the summer months are 20,000 to 30,000 gpd; typical flow rates in the non-summer months are 2,000 to 5,000 gpd.

8. Wastewater flows through a gravity sewer system to a central pump station, where it is pumped to the package treatment plant. The package treatment plant discharges to a polishing/percolation pond, which in turn discharges to leachfields which occupy an area of approximately two acres. The polishing pond is equipped with a spray aeration device which recirculates the wastewater in the pond.
9. Sludge and grit are re-circulated within the treatment plant. The plant clarifier returns both settled and floating materials to the plant headworks, in a plug flow operation. Excess biosolids within the plant are partly to completely oxidized in one aeration tank during the months of October and November.
10. The system operates year round. The pond does not freeze in the winter.
11. Annual precipitation at Yosemite Lakes Campground is approximately 35 inches. The annual evaporation rate for this area is reported to be 50 inches per year.
12. Domestic water supply is provided by a spring, which is outside the NACO West basin and approximately 4,000 feet away from, and topographically higher than the wastewater treatment plant. Water is chlorinated and treated with sand filters and carbon prior to storage and delivery.
13. The site lies within the San Joaquin Basin, Hydrologic Unit No. 536.80, as depicted on interagency hydrologic maps prepared by the Department of Water Resources in August 1986.
14. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Fourth Edition, for the Sacramento River Basin and the San Joaquin River Basin (hereafter Basin Plan), which contains water quality objectives for all water of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
15. The beneficial uses of the Tuolumne River via South Fork Tuolumne River are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation; aesthetic enjoyment; navigation; fresh water replenishment; preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife, and other aquatic resources.
16. Beneficial uses of the underlying groundwater in the camp include domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
17. The action to update waste discharge requirements for this facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.
18. This discharge is exempt from the requirements of Title 27, CCR, Section 20080, et seq. The exemption, pursuant to Section 20090 (b), is based on the following:
 - a. the Board is issuing waste discharge requirements, and
 - b. the discharge complies with the Basin Plan, and

- c. the wastewater does not need to be managed according to 22 CCR, Division 4.5, Chapter 11 as hazardous waste.
19. The Board has notified the Discharger, interested agencies, and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
20. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 86-156 is rescinded and that Yosemite Lakes Campground, Naco West, and Thousand Trails Inc., their agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of waste to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous' under Section 2521, Chapter 15 of Title 23 or 'designated', as defined in Section 13173 of California Water Code is prohibited.
4. Surfacing of wastewater in the leachfield is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The disposal flow to the designated disposal area shall not exceed the capacity of the leachfields. The leachfield shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow as well as inflow and infiltration during the wet season.
2. The average dry weather discharge flow shall not exceed 50,000 gallons per day.
3. The leachfields shall be maintained so that at no time will sewage surface at any location.
4. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and disposal areas, including the leachfield area.
5. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. 3, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.

6. The Discharger's wastewater treatment plant shall be designed, constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to floods with a 100-year return frequency.
7. The storage pond shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
8. The storage pond shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. In particular,
 - a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
9. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and other acceptable alternatives.
10. The storage pond shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow, designed seasonal precipitation, and ancillary inflow and infiltration. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with the historical rainfall patterns.
11. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet, as measured vertically from the water surface to the lowest dike or levee.
12. On or about 1 October each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specifications No. 10 and No. 11.
13. Treated wastewater effluent shall not exceed the discharge limits presented below. The limits are based on water quality criteria designed to protect all beneficial uses of the underlying groundwater. If two monitoring events show the effluent exceeds the limits presented below, then within **90 days** of request by the Executive Officer, the Discharger shall submit a technical report which describes how compliance will be accomplished. Installation of groundwater monitoring wells may be required if wastewater does not meet the listed effluent standards.

<u>Treatment Plant Effluent</u> <u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly</u> <u>Average</u>	<u>Daily</u> <u>Maximum</u>
BOD ₅	mg/l	40	80
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	40	80

<u>Pond Effluent Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly Average</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
Nitrate (as Nitrogen)	mg/l	10	20
Ammonia (as Nitrogen)	mg/l	0.5	1.0
Zinc	mg/l	2.1	5.0
Phenol	mg/l	0.005	4.2
Formaldehyde	mg/l	0.030	0.60

C. Sludge Disposal

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with both Title 27, Division 2, Subdivision 1 and Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 15 of the California Code of Regulations and approved by the Executive Officer.
2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice from a previously approved practice shall be reported to this office Executive Officer and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage sludge shall comply with existing Federal and State laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503. If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards are given the authority to implement regulation contained in 40 CFR 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The Discharger must comply with the standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR 503 whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

D. Groundwater Limitations

The discharge, in combination with other sources, shall not cause underlying groundwater to contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality, except for coliform bacteria. For coliform bacteria, increases shall not cause the most probable number of total coliform organisms to exceed 2.2 MPN/ml over any 7-day period.

E. Provisions

1. By **30 June 2000**, the Discharger shall submit a Polishing Pond Storage Capacity Evaluation workplan to determine (a) whether the pond meets the storage capacity requirements of Discharge Specifications No. B.10 and B.11, (b) the current depth of sludge in the pond, and (c) procedures to monitor the future depth of sludge in the pond.

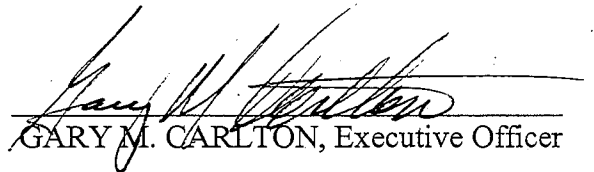
2. Within **90 days of staff approval of the workplan**, the Discharger shall submit a Polishing Pond Storage Capacity report. The report shall include a proposal for cleaning the sludge out of the pond on a regular basis. If the report shows that the pond does not meet the capacity requirements of this Order, then the Discharger shall also provide a workplan and proposed timeline to bring the pond into compliance with this Order.
3. The Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 5-00-54, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
4. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
5. The Discharger shall use the best practicable cost-effective control techniques(s) currently available to minimize mineralization and to comply with the discharge limits specified in this Order.
6. The Discharger shall report promptly to the Board any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.
7. The Discharger shall submit to the Board, on or before each compliance report due date, the specified document, or if appropriate, a written report detailing compliance or noncompliance with the specific schedule date and task. If noncompliance is reported, then the Discharger shall state the reasons for noncompliance and shall provide a schedule to come into compliance.
8. Package treatment plant cleanings removing grit and biosolids shall be performed only by a duly authorized service.
9. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.
10. At least **90 days** prior to termination or expiration of any lease, contract, or agreement involving disposal or reclamation areas or off-site reuse of effluent, used to justify the capacity authorized herein and assure compliance with their Order, the Discharger shall notify the Board in writing of the situation and of what measures have been taken or are being taken to assure full compliance with this Order.

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11. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring correction action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
12. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
13. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 17 March 2000.


GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 5-00-054

FOR
NACO WEST AND THOUSAND TRAILS, INC.
YOSEMITE LAKES CAMPGROUND
WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITY
TUOLUMNE COUNTY

This monitoring and reporting program (MRP) incorporates requirements for monitoring of the treatment process, stored effluent, and leachfield. This MRP is issued pursuant to Water Code Section 13267. The Discharger shall not implement any changes to this MRP unless and until a revised MRP is issued by the Executive Officer. Specific sample station locations shall be approved by Executive Officer prior to implementation of sampling activities.

PACKAGE TREATMENT PLANT EFFLUENT MONITORING

The following shall constitute the effluent monitoring program:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling/Reporting Frequency</u>
Flow	Gpd	Cumulative	Continuous
BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	Grab	Monthly

BOD₅ denotes 5-day Biochemical Oxygen Demand at 20°C

POND EFFLUENT MONITORING

Pond effluent samples shall be collected prior to discharge to the leachfield. Samples should be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge. Time of collection of grab samples shall be recorded, and shall be between 0800 and 0900 hours. The following shall constitute the pond effluent monitoring program:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling/Reporting Frequency</u>
Pond Freeboard	feet	Measurement	Monthly
PH	pH Units	Grab	Monthly
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Total Coliform Organisms	MPN/100 ml	Grab	Quarterly

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling/Reporting Frequency</u>
Nitrate (as nitrogen)	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Ammonia (as nitrogen)	mg/l	Grab	Monthly
Formaldehyde	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly
Zinc	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly
Phenol	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly

LEACHFIELD MONITORING

Leachfield monitoring will consist of visual inspection of the leachfield and nearby area. The leachfield and the area downslope of the leachfield shall be inspected on a monthly basis for the presence of wet areas, leachate or groundwater seepage, objectionable odors, and/or unexpected plant growth. Leachfield monitoring results shall be included with all monthly monitoring reports.

REPORTING

In reporting monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, sample type (e.g., influent, effluent, etc.), and reported analytical result for each sample are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to clearly illustrate compliance with waste discharge requirements and spatial or temporal trends, as applicable. A narrative description of the leachfield monitoring shall identify the inspector, date, and statements addressing, at a minimum, all the items listed above. The results of any monitoring done more frequently than required at the locations specified in the Monitoring and Reporting Program shall be reported to the Regional Board in the next regularly scheduled monitoring report.

A. Monthly Reports

Monthly Monitoring Reports for influent, and leachfield monitoring shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the **30th day of the following month.**

B. Annual Monitoring Report

The December Monthly Report (due by **30 January** of each year) shall also serve as an Annual Monitoring Report. At a minimum, the Annual Monitoring Report shall include the following:

1. The contents of a regular monthly report.

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2. If requested by the Executive Officer, tabular and graphical summaries of all monitoring data obtained during the previous year (including influent, leachfield, and pond data).
3. A discussion of compliance and the corrective action taken, as well as any planned or proposed actions needed to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.
4. A discussion of any data gaps and potential deficiencies/redundancies in the monitoring system or reporting program.

The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program as of the date of this Order.

Ordered by:


GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

17 March 2000

(Date)

JRM: 3/17/00

INFORMATION SHEET

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. 5-00-054
NACO WEST AND THOUSAND TRAILS, INC.
WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITY

On 28 December 1999, Naco West, and Thousand Trails, Inc. (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge to discharge its treated wastewater to land. The wastewater treatment and disposal facilities are owned and operated by the Discharger. The discharge is occurring at Yosemite Lakes Campground, which occupies approximately 12 acres. The site is at 31191 Hardin Flat Road, approximately 3,700 feet above mean sea level, approximately 18 miles east of Groveland, Tuolumne County. Camp facilities include 431 campsites, 267 of which provide recreational vehicle connection to the wastewater system.

The campground operates year round but the majority of visitors arrive between May and September. From October to April the facility is normally occupied by approximately five employees. During the peak summer occupancy period, the campground can accommodate approximately 2,150 people. Flow rates vary from approximately 2,000 to 5,000 gallons per day (gpd) in the non-summer months, to approximately 20,000 to 30,000 gpd in the summer months.

Wastewater is treated in a package treatment plant, a polishing pond, and discharge to percolation beds. The capacity of the wastewater system is 50,000 gpd. Wastewater is collected in a gravity sewer system to a central pumping station, where it is pumped to the package treatment plant. The oxidation pond has a spray aeration device which recirculates the wastewater in the pond. The wastewater treatment plant operates year-round. Wastewater is not disinfected prior to discharge.

JRM: 3/17/00

